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General Knowledge

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STUDY NOTES

Books & Authors -International

Important Books and Authors - International

Books are not just a window to the world's history and cultures but also powerful tools that shape **ideologies**, challenge **perceptions**, and inspire generations.

From the **philosophical** musings of ancient thinkers like Plato to the magical adventures in J.K. Rowling's Harry Potter literature has always been a reflection of the human experience.

This curated guide presents a comprehensive list of such landmark works and their creators, designed to help you ace the "Books and Authors" section in exams while gaining a deeper appreciation for their influence on the world.

Major Books and Authors:

Book Title	Author	Year of Release	Genre/Category	Awards
The Kite Runner	Khaled Hosseini	2003	Fiction	South African Boeke Prize (2004)
The Da Vinci Code	Dan Brown	2003	Thriller/Crime	No major awards, but highly popular
Harry Potter and the Goblet of Fire	J.K. Rowling	2000	Fantasy	Hugo Award (2001), Locus Award
The Alchemist	Paulo Coelho	2005	Fiction	Crystal Award, 2006 (World Economic Forum)
A Brief History of Time	Stephen Hawking	2000	Science	CBE (Commander of the Order of the British Empire)

Shantaram	Gregory David Roberts	2003	Fiction	No major awards
The Hunger Games	Suzanne Collins	2008	Dystopian Fiction	Teen Choice Award, 2010
Life of Pi	Yann Martel	2001	Fiction	Booker Prize (2002)
The Immortals of Meluha	Amish Tripathi	2010	Fiction/Historical	No major awards
The 5th Mountain	Paulo Coelho	2000	Fiction	No major awards
Sapiens: A Brief History of Humankind	Yuval Noah Harari	2011	Non-fiction/History	No major awards
The White Tiger	Aravind Adiga	2008	Fiction	Man Booker Prize (2008)
The Road	Cormac McCarthy	2006	Fiction	Pulitzer Prize for Fiction (2007)
Where the Crawdads Sing	Delia Owens	2018	Mystery/Thriller	Reese Witherspoon's Book Club Pick, 2019
The Night Circus	Erin Morgenstern	2011	Fantasy	Locus Award (2012)
The Underground Railroad	Colson Whitehead	2016	Historical Fiction	Pulitzer Prize for Fiction (2017)

The Testaments	Margaret Atwood	2019	Dystopian Fiction	Booker Prize (2019)
Normal People	Sally Rooney	2018	Fiction	Booker Prize Shortlist (2019)
Educated	Tara Westover	2018	Memoir	Goodreads Choice Award (2018)
The Midnight Library	Matt Haig	2020	Fiction	Goodreads Choice Award for Fiction (2020)
The Priory of the Orange Tree	Samantha Shannon	2019	Fantasy	No major awards
A Little Life	Hanya Yanagihara	2015	Fiction	Booker Prize Shortlist (2015)
The Silent Patient	Alex Michaelides	2019	Thriller/Mystery	Goodreads Choice Award for Mystery & Thriller (2019)
The Seven Husbands of Evelyn Hugo	Taylor Jenkins Reid	2017	Fiction/Romance	Goodreads Choice Award for Historical Fiction (2017)
The Vanishing Half	Brit Bennett	2020	Fiction	Goodreads Choice Award for Historical Fiction (2020)

The Midnight Library	Matt Haig	2020	Fiction	Goodreads Choice Award for Fiction (2020)
The Book Thief	Markus Zusak	2005	Historical Fiction	Michael L. Printz Honor (2006)
Becoming	Michelle Obama	2018	Memoir	No major literary awards, but highly popular
Circe	Madeline Miller	2018	Fantasy	Orange Prize for Fiction (2012)
The Night Watchman	Louise Erdrich	2020	Fiction	Pulitzer Prize for Fiction (2021)
All the Light We Cannot See	Anthony Doerr	2014	Historical Fiction	Pulitzer Prize for Fiction (2015)
The Song of Achilles	Madeline Miller	2011	Fantasy	Orange Prize for Fiction (2012)
American Dirt	Jeanine Cummins	2020	Fiction	No major awards
The Giver of Stars	Jojo Moyes	2020	Historical Fiction	No major awards
Little Fires Everywhere	Celeste Ng	2017	Fiction	Goodreads Choice Award for Fiction (2017)

The Shadow of the Wind	Carlos Ruiz Zafón	2001	Fiction	No major awards but highly popular
Big Little Lies	Liane Moriarty	2014	Fiction	Goodreads Choice Award (2014)
An American Marriage	Tayari Jones	2018	Fiction	Women's Prize for Fiction (2019)
The Girl on the Train	Paula Hawkins	2015	Thriller/Mystery	No major awards but highly popular
The Book of M	Peng Shepherd	2018	Science Fiction	No major awards
The Water Dancer	Ta-Nehisi Coates	2019	Fiction	No major awards
The Invisible Man	Ralph Ellison	1952	Fiction	National Book Award (1953)
The Tattooist of Auschwitz	Heather Morris	2018	Historical Fiction	No major awards
The Wife Between Us	Greer Hendricks & Sarah Pekkanen	2018	Thriller/Mystery	No major awards
The Girl with the Louding Voice	Abi Daré	2020	Fiction	Goodreads Choice Award for Debut Fiction (2020)

The Great Alone	Kristin Hannah	2018	Fiction	No major awards
Before We Were Strangers	Renée Carlino	2015	Romance	Goodreads Choice Award Nominee (2015)
The Rosie Project	Graeme Simsion	2013	Romance	No major awards
The Ocean at the End of the Lane	Neil Gaiman	2013	Fantasy	British Fantasy Award (2013)
The Paris Library	Janet Skeslien Charles	2020	Historical Fiction	No major awards
The Nightingale	Kristin Hannah	2015	Historical Fiction	Goodreads Choice Award (2015)
A Man Called Ove	Fredrik Backman	2012	Fiction	Goodreads Choice Award (2013)
The Goldfinch	Donna Tartt	2013	Fiction	Pulitzer Prize for Fiction (2014)
The Girl in the Spider's Web	David Lagercrantz	2015	Thriller	No major awards
The Couple Next Door	Shari Lapena	2016	Thriller	No major awards

The 5th Wave	Rick Yancey	2013	Sci-Fi	No major awards
The Outsiders	S.E. Hinton	1967	Fiction	No major awards
The Hate U Give	Angie Thomas	2017	YA Fiction	William C. Morris Award (2018)
The Catcher in the Rye	J.D. Salinger	1951	Fiction	No major awards
The Goldfinch	Donna Tartt	2013	Fiction	Pulitzer Prize for Fiction (2014)
The Bell Jar	Sylvia Plath	1963	Fiction	No major awards
The Book Thief	Markus Zusak	2005	Historical Fiction	Michael L. Printz Honor (2006)
The Road	Cormac McCarthy	2006	Fiction	Pulitzer Prize (2007)
The Girl Who Lived	Christopher Greyson	2016	Thriller	No major awards

Books in News in 2024

Book Title	Author	Year of Release	Genre/Category	Awards/Recognition
The Last Emperors of India	Shashi Tharoor	2024	History	No major awards yet
The Seven Moons of Maali Almeida	Shehan Karunatilaka	2024	Fiction	Booker Prize (2022) – Still relevant for 2024 discussions
The Climate Crisis: A Radical Case for Hope	Tim Flannery	2024	Non-fiction/Environment	No major awards yet
Tomorrow, and Tomorrow, and Tomorrow	Gabrielle Zevin	2024	Fiction	Goodreads Choice Award (2022) – Relevant for 2024 discussions
The Book of Goose	Yiyun Li	2024	Fiction	Finalist for National Book Award
The Winds of Winter	George R.R. Martin	2024 (anticipated)	Fantasy	No awards yet, but highly anticipated
Rising Tides	D.J. Molles	2024	Sci-Fi	No major awards yet
Revolutionary Ideas	Amartya Sen	2024	Non-fiction	No major awards yet (likely future impact)

A Promised Land	Barack Obama	2024 Edition	Memoir/Politics	Grammy Award for Best Spoken Word (2021)
Our Lady of the Nile	Scholastique Mukasonga	2024	Fiction	No major awards yet, but highly acclaimed in literary circles
The Shadow of the Gods	John Gwynne	2024	Fantasy	No major awards yet
The Unsung Hero	Amitav Ghosh	2024	Historical Fiction	No major awards yet
The Devil's Advocate	John Grisham	2024	Legal Thriller	No major awards yet
The Last White Man	Mohsin Hamid	2024	Fiction	No major awards yet